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UNIVERSITY OF GHANA

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DEPARTMENT OF TEACHER EDUCATION

SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP

COLLEGES OF EDUCATION

END OF FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS FOR LEVEL 300, 2023/2024

B.ED. PROGRAMME

COURSE CODE: **TEJS 337**

COURSE TITLE: **INTRODUCTION TO AFRICAN TRADITIONAL RELIGION**

Instruction: Answer **all** questions in Section A and any **three** questions in Section B.

Time: 2 hours

SECTION A

1. Which of these is not a source for studying ATR?
   A. Songs
   B. Proverbs
   C. Belief in God
   D. Totemism

2. Which of these is not a source of morality in ATR?
   A. Derge
   B. Songs
   C. Holy book
   D. Proverbs

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3. African traditional religion is preserved also through oral traditions such as .....
   A. Belief in the end time
   B. Incarnation
   C. Recitals
   D. Traditional Songs

4. Religious ideas and practices sprang up simultaneously in different parts of the continent of Africa because...
   A. The people related one to another
   B. The people shared similar cultural heritage
   C. The people were determined to be religious
   D. There was communal bonding among the people

5. One common misconception people hold about African traditional religion is that .....
   A. The religion has fetish elements
   B. The religion has no founder
   C. The religion is seen as colloquial
   D. The religion is without attraction

6. African traditional religion draws its potency and authority from its oral materials such as ....
   A. Proverbs, Chieftaincy, and festivals
   B. Proverbs, festivals, and dancing
   C. Proverbs, tales, and counsel
   D. Proverbs, traditional songs, and myths

7. Apart from the Guardian-Spirits, what are the other two types of spirits believed by African traditionalists?
   A. Ghost spirit and ancestors
   B. Born to die spirit and evil spirit
   C. Ghost spirit and born to die spirit
   D. Born to die spirit and ancestors

8. In African societies....
   A. Religion is an integral part of the lives of the people.
   B. Religion is not an integral part of the lives of the people.
   C. Religion is not part of morality
   D. Membership is by baptism

9. The term used to describe things, actions or sayings which society see as unacceptable and therefore reject them is .....
   A. Totemism.
   B. Taboos
   C. Myths
   D. Legends

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10. In most African communities, proverbs contain religious ideas and are passed on from one generation to another. These proverbs help shape…
    A. The moral and social life of the people
    B. The religious and economic life of the people
    C. The religious and moral life of the people
    D. The social and economic life of the people

11. People in Africa have their own arts and symbols with different meanings. These arts and symbols express ……..
    A. Diplomatic heritage
    B. Intellectual and religious ideas
    C. Political and religious ideas
    D. Religious and cultural ideas

12. Among Africans, one of the following must apply to qualify a dead relative as an ancestor.
    A. He must be a spiritual leader
    B. He must be married with many children
    C. He must fulfill all cultural obligations in the community
    D. He must obtain a large size of farms

13. One of the key roles that ancestors play is that…
    A. They ensure smooth marriage among their kinsmen
    B. They provide spiritual protection for their surviving kinsmen
    C. They punish wrongdoers in the community
    D. They teach surviving kinsmen the way of their religion

14. Which aspect of the life of the African that we cannot find the scriptures of ATR?
    A. Social institution
    B. Political institution.
    C. Marriage
    D. Agricultural institution

15. Animals or objects which are forbidden to be eaten or harmed are known as …….
    A. Taboos
    B. Supper natural beings
    C. Poisonous beings.
    D. Totems

16. The act of pouring out of a liquid such as water, wine or oil, as a sacrifice to God, the divinities or in honour of a dead person is termed as.....
    A. Convocation.
    B. Offering.
    C. Libation.
    D. Prayer.

17. In ATR, one of these is not a factor to consider when giving a name to a child
    A. Date of birth
    B. Place of birth
    C. Gender
    D. Day of birth

18. In African Traditional Religion, it is believed that death is not the end of man but also .....
    A. an everlasting journey
    B. change of one's human status to a spiritual being
    C. opportunity to become an ancestor
    D. transition to the spiritual world

19. What does the *Gye Nyame* symbol (which means *except God*) signify in Akan indigenous religion?
    A. God as the creator of the universe
    B. God's omnipresence
    C. The omnipotence of God
    D. The truth of God

20. A common misconception people hold about African traditional religion is that .....
    A. It is a religion of idol worship
    B. It is a religion of medium
    C. It is the religion of the illiterates
    D. It is the religion of the poor

21. Why is naming a child after someone is of great essence in African traditional religion in Ghana?
    A. So that the child will be wealthy
    B. So that the child will grow up like the person
    C. So that the child will live long like the person
    D. So that the child will possess the moral character of the person

22. Though in ATR everybody belief in God, not all of them believe that God.....
    A. Has no images what so ever.
    B. Has only one type of gender attribute
    C. Cannot be seen
    D. Is above us

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23. The basis for the belief in ancestors lies in the general worldwide belief that communication takes place between the ..... and the ..... and that the .....can be of .....to the.....
    A. Liven, dead, dead, help, liven
    B. Dead, liven, dead, help, liven
    C. Dead, liven, dead, kill, liven
    D. Liven, dead, dead, kill, liven

24. The Damba festival is celebrated by the.....
    A. Dagomba
    B. Gonja
    C. Waala
    D. Mamprusi

25. All the following are reasons why formal worship is done in certain times except.....
    A. There is a special manifestation of the spirits at these times.
    B. It is also to remember a good or bad event which occurred in the history of the community.
    C. It is the choice of a deity to be worshipped on a particular day.
    D. It is the choice of the items to be used on a particular day for worship.

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SECTION B [75 Marks]

Answer **any three** questions in this section.

1. Critically analyze five possible barriers to the teaching and learning of African traditional religion in basic schools in Ghana.

(25 Marks)

2. A. Mention any five types of ATR prayers **(5 Marks)**
   B. Examine the four step-by-step structure of an ATR prayer **(20 Marks)**
3. Define cultural values and comment on any four importance of each of the following among indigenous Ghanaians.
   b. Family system
   c. Human beings
   d. Communal value.

4. A. In the context of ATR, explain the term myth **(5 Marks)**
   B. Write on any four types of myths believed in ATR **(20 Marks)**
5. Explain any five errors of terminologies used by western writers in describing ATR

(25 Marks)